Did traders change their mind after the hike?

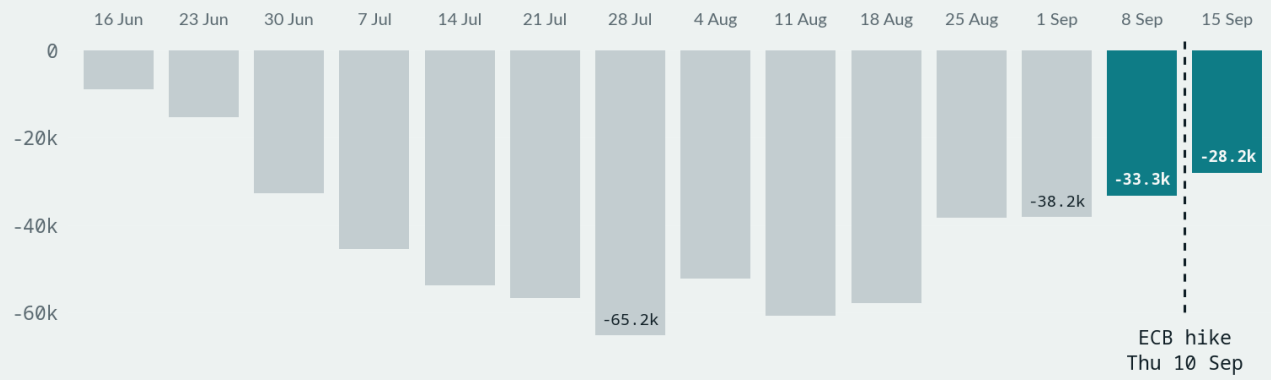
Leveraged funds in CME euro futures, from the CFTC report released Friday 18 September. Positions are as of Tuesday 15 September, the first print taken after the ECB's 10 September hike.

NET, 1 SEP
−38,173
4.4% of open interest

NET, 8 SEP (LAST BEFORE)
−33,285
3.5% of open interest

NET, 15 SEP (FIRST AFTER)
−28,156
3.1% of open interest

01 Fourteen weeks of net positioning



Net contracts, leveraged funds, euro FX futures, 16 Jun to 15 Sep 2026. The two highlighted prints sit either side of the ECB decision.

02 Before and after

Leveraged funds were net short 38,173 euro contracts on 1 September and 33,285 on 8 September, the last print before the 10 September decision, so the net short was already narrowing before the hike. On 15 September, the first print after it, the net short was 28,156: a further 5,129 contracts narrower, against 4,888 the week before.

TIMING NOTE

Positions are as of Tuesday and published the following Friday, so they lag. The 8 September print was taken two days before the decision and released on 11 September. The 15 September print was taken five days after it and released on 18 September. Any reaction on 10 and 11 September is mixed into the 15 September number with whatever happened from 11 to 15 September.

03 Who moved, by category

NET POSITION BY CATEGORY	1 SEP	8 SEP	15 SEP	CHANGE 8 TO 15 SEP
Leveraged funds	-38,173	-33,285	-28,156	+5,129
Asset managers	+263,253	+250,678	+251,698	+1,020
Dealers	-267,578	-261,454	-258,080	+3,374
Other reportables	+8,846	+8,175	+7,755	-420
Nonreportables	+33,652	+35,886	+26,783	-9,103

Net is long minus short outright positions. All 17 weeks and the formulas are in the Excel file. The 15 September print falls in the quarterly contract roll week, when open interest moves for unrelated reasons.

04 What the week shows

The hike was expected. The ECB's July account had a September move "almost fully priced in" at the time of that meeting, and the Monday week-ahead treated 25 basis points as the base case. The ECB delivered exactly that. The euro barely moved: the ECB reference rate was 1.1616 on 10 September, set around the time of the decision, and 1.1592 on 11 September, the first fixing after it, a fall of 0.21%.

Positioning tells the same story. Funds did not change course on the news. The net short kept narrowing at almost the same pace as the week before (5,129 contracts against 4,888) and stayed small, at 3.1% of open interest. So the answer is no: traders did not change their mind after the hike, they kept trimming the short as before.

> THREAD: Was this week's quiet reaction normal? Next: the eight-meeting study.

SOURCES

1. CFTC, Traders in Financial Futures, Futures Only, EURO FX (CME, code 099741), positions as of 26 May to 15 Sep 2026. Accessed 19 Oct 2026. https://publicreporting.cftc.gov/Commitments-of-Traders/Traders-in-Financial-Futures-Futures-Only/gpe5-46if
2. CFTC, Commitments of Traders, 2026 release schedule (reports on 11 and 18 Sep 2026). Accessed 21 Oct 2026. https://www.cftc.gov/MarketReports/CommitmentsofTraders/ReleaseSchedule/index.htm
3. CFTC, Commitments of Traders, report definitions. Accessed 19 Oct 2026. https://www.cftc.gov/MarketReports/CommitmentsofTraders/index.htm
4. ECB, monetary policy decisions, 10 Sep 2026 (25 basis point hike). https://www.ecb.europa.eu/press/pr/date/2026/html/ecb.mp260910~314e508016.en.html
5. ECB, account of the July meeting, 27 Aug 2026. https://www.ecb.europa.eu/press/accounts/2026/html/ecb.mg260827~f06c21fd54.en.html
6. ECB, euro reference rates, US dollar (10 Sep 1.1616; 11 Sep 1.1592). Accessed 19 Oct 2026. https://www.ecb.europa.eu/stats/policy_and_exchange_rates/euro_reference_exchange_rates/html/eurofxref-graph-usd.en.html

Independent portfolio project built from public data. Not investment advice.